

BEFORE THE STATE BOARD OF LICENSED PROFESSIONAL COUNSELOR EXAMINERS

STATE OF COLORADO

Case Nos. 2022-4844 and 2024-1518

STIPULATION AND FINAL AGENCY ORDER

IN THE MATTER OF DISCIPLINARY PROCEEDINGS REGARDING THE LICENSE TO PRACTICE PROFESSIONAL COUNSELING IN THE STATE OF COLORADO OF MATTHEW JAMES JUNGAS, LICENSE NO. LPC.14800,

Respondent.

IT IS HEREBY STIPULATED by and between the State Board of Professional Counseling Examiners ("Board") and Matthew James Jungas ("Respondent"), as follows:

1. The Board has jurisdiction over the person of Respondent and the subject matter of this Stipulation and Final Agency Order ("Order").

2. Respondent was licensed to practice as a Licensed Professional Counselor ("LPC") in the State of Colorado at all times relevant herein.

3. This Order is a full and final resolution of case numbers 2022-4844 and 2024-1518. This Order does not resolve any other cases, complaints, or matters, known or unknown to the Board or Respondent, as of the effective date of this Order.

4. Respondent admits the following:

a. Respondent engaged in a dual relationship with a client and exchanged hundreds of text messages with that client.

5. By virtue of the facts admitted in paragraph 4 above, Respondent admits and the Board finds that Respondent violated section 12-245-224(1)(k), C.R.S., which states:

12-245-224. Prohibited activities--related provisions. (1) A person licensed, registered, or certified under this article 245 violates this article 245 if he or she:

(k) Has failed to terminate a relationship with a client when it was reasonably clear that the client was not benefitting from the relationship and is not likely to gain such benefit in the future;

6. By virtue of the admissions in paragraphs 4 and 5 above, Respondent is subject to the following disciplinary sanction(s) that the Board believes is necessary to protect the public health, safety, and welfare.

PROBATION

7. Respondent's license to practice as a licensed professional counselor in the State of Colorado is hereby placed on probation for three (3) years, commencing from the effective date of this Order or the date Respondent's practice monitor is approved, whichever date is later. During the probationary period, Respondent shall be bound by the terms and restrictions set forth in this Order.

8. The period of probation is tolled during any time that Respondent is not practicing in this state, and such period of probation shall resume at such time as Respondent resumes practicing in the State of Colorado in accordance with this Order.

9. Credit toward the period of probation will be given only for the period of time during which Respondent is practicing as a licensed professional counselor in Colorado, is being monitored by a practice monitor, and is in full compliance with all terms of this Order.

10. Respondent may request early termination of this probationary period, in writing, after successful completion of two years.

11. If, at the end of the probationary period, Respondent has adhered to all terms and conditions of this Order, Respondent may request termination of probation. Request for termination of probation must be made in writing to the Board, and Respondent is responsible for establishing, to the satisfaction of the Board, that he has satisfied all terms and conditions of probation.

PRACTICE MONITOR

12. During the term of probation, Respondent's practice shall be monitored by a practice monitor. If the Board has not already approved Respondent's practice monitor, Respondent must follow the same steps as outlined in paragraph 11 above in order to secure a practice monitor.

13. Respondent must have a practice monitor approved by the Board within two (2) months of the effective date of this Order. If this requirement is not satisfied, Respondent must cease practice and agrees to suspension of his practice until a practice monitor is approved unless an extension is granted by the Board.

14. After the Board's written approval of the practice monitor, Respondent and the practice monitor shall enter into a written contract for monitoring within 30 days. If this requirement is not satisfied, Respondent must cease practice and agrees to suspension of his practice until the written contract for practice monitoring is executed unless an extension is granted by the Board. The practice monitor shall

provide a copy of the written contract to the Board as a part of his/her first report to the Board. The contract must contain a provision stating that the practice monitor has received a copy of this Order, the complaint and responsive documents, any investigative report, and the practice evaluation; has read these documents; and understands the duties and responsibilities s/he is undertaking as Respondent's practice monitor. The practice monitor shall ensure that a written notification is provided to each of Respondent's clients, informing the clients of the name, address, and telephone number of the practice monitor. This written notification may be provided in a mandatory disclosure statement.

15. The practice monitor shall conduct a practice evaluation during the first month of practice monitoring. The practice evaluation shall examine all aspects of Respondent's practice or proposed practice and his qualifications and ability to practice in accordance with generally accepted standards of practice and with skill and safety for clients, and determine whether he has the necessary qualifications, current ability, and competence to practice. The first practice monitoring report shall include the findings of the practice evaluation.

16. Should the Board determine from the practice monitor's evaluation that Respondent cannot practice any part of his practice with skill and safety for clients in accordance with generally accepted standards of practice or does not have the appropriate qualifications, ability, or competence for practice, Respondent shall immediately cease any part of the practice that the Board determines, based on the evaluation, he is not qualified, competent, or safe to conduct. Based on the Board's findings and the evaluation, the Board will determine necessary actions that Respondent must take and conditions Respondent must meet so that Respondent can practice with skill and safety for clients in accordance with generally accepted standards of practice in any areas the Board finds Respondent is not qualified, competent, and safe to practice. Once Respondent satisfies the Board that he is qualified, competent, and safe to fully practice, Respondent may resume full practice.

17. The practice monitoring shall consist of individual, in-person (face-to-face) sessions that occur for one (1) hour, or such longer time as the practice monitor deems necessary, for every twenty (20) hours of client contact, but at least once each month. Respondent and his practice monitor must review and discuss each of Respondent's active cases at least once every month in order to allow the practice monitor to be able to determine whether Respondent is practicing as a licensed professional counselor in accordance with generally accepted standards of practice and with skill and safety for his clients.

18. The practice monitor shall submit a written report to the Board on the fifth day of the month following the first full month of practice monitoring. All subsequent reports shall be submitted on the fifth day of each month for the first twelve (12) reports. After the submission of the first twelve (12) reports, unless otherwise ordered by the Board, the practice monitor shall submit his/her reports by the fifth day of every third month (i.e. on a quarterly basis) until the practice monitoring is completed.

19. If at any time the Board has questions or concerns regarding the monitoring, the practice monitor agrees to attend any Board meeting necessary to address the Board's concerns. The Board will give the practice monitor 30 days notice prior to requiring the practice monitor's attendance at the Board meeting.

20. If at any time the practice monitor believes Respondent is not in compliance with this Order, is unable to practice with skill and safety to his clients, or has committed a violation of the practice act or rules and regulations, the practice monitor shall immediately notify the Board, in writing, and include the basis for this conclusion. A copy will be sent to Respondent. Upon submission of such a report, Respondent shall immediately cease the practice of licensed professional counseling.

21. Respondent shall make every effort to ensure that all reports by the practice monitor are complete and timely submitted to the Board. If, in the Board's judgment, the practice monitor fails to perform the function specified by this Order, the Board may require that a new practice monitor assume the responsibilities herein. If for any reason the practice monitor ceases to perform the functions specified in this Order, Respondent shall submit, in writing, a new proposed practice monitor to the Board within 30 days.

22. Respondent or the practice monitor may terminate the monitoring relationship upon written notice to the other and to the Board not less than 60 days before the date of termination. The notice shall state the reason for the termination. Respondent shall immediately initiate efforts to obtain another Board-approved practice monitor, who shall conduct his/her monitoring and report to the Board in accordance with this Order.

CONTINUING EDUCATION

23. During the period of probation, Respondent must successfully complete at least twenty-six (26) hours of Board-approved professional continuing education ("CE") courses each year in the areas of boundaries, ethics, and dual relationships. Respondent shall obtain Board approval of the courses prior to enrolling in each course. Upon completion of a course, Respondent shall ensure that a certificate of completion is provided to the Board.

24. These continuing education and program hours completed pursuant to this section shall be required in addition to, and may not be counted toward, the mandatory Continuing Professional Development requirements for an active Colorado license or to meet any other licensure requirements.

TERMS AND CONDITIONS

25. Respondent will strictly observe the prohibitions set forth in section 12-245-224, C.R.S., and will ensure that he does not engage in any activities that are prohibited and that he practices in accordance with the generally accepted standards of practice.

26. Respondent shall not supervise or consult with other mental health providers for the purpose of those persons providing mental health services, unless such supervision or consultation is monitored in accordance with this Order.

27. All expenses incurred or necessary to fulfill the terms of this Order, shall be the sole responsibility of Respondent and not the Board.

28. In the event Respondent relocates at any time during the probationary period, Respondent shall notify the Board of the change of address within 30 days of the effective date of such change.

29. Respondent is fully aware of and understands the right to receive a formal notice of hearing and charges and to have a formal disciplinary hearing, pursuant to sections 12-20-403 and 12-245-226, C.R.S., and hereby waives those rights. Further, Respondent also acknowledges that this waiver constitutes a waiver of all rights to appeal in this matter.

30. This Order is entered into by Respondent voluntarily and without coercion, after an opportunity to consult with counsel and with full understanding of the legal consequences of this Order and the right to formal hearing on all matters herein.

31. This Order shall become an order of the Board when it is accepted and signed by the Program Director or authorized Board representative.

32. The Order entered pursuant to this Stipulation and Final Agency Order shall constitute a Board order for purposes of section 12-245-224, C.R.S., and shall have the same force and effect as an order entered after a formal disciplinary hearing pursuant to sections 12-20-403 and 12-245-226, C.R.S.

33. Respondent acknowledges and agrees that any violation of this Order shall constitute a violation of a lawful Board Order and be grounds for further proceedings pursuant to the Mental Health Practice Act and, if proven, may constitute a basis for further disciplinary action. The pendency of any disciplinary action shall not affect the obligation of Respondent to comply with the terms of this Order, and this Order shall remain operative and in full force and effect.

34. This Order constitutes the entire agreement between Respondent and the Board. There are no other promises expressed or implied. In the event that any provision of this Order is deemed unenforceable by a court of competent jurisdiction, such provision shall be severed, and the remainder of this Order shall be given full force and effect.

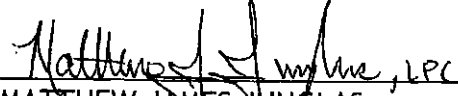
35. This Order shall become effective upon (a) mailing by first-class mail to Respondent at Respondent's address of record with the Board, or (b) service by electronic means on Respondent at Respondent's electronic address of record with the Board. Respondent hereby consents to service by electronic means if Respondent has an electronic address on file with the Board.

36. This Order shall be admissible as evidence at any hearing held before the Board.

37. This Order shall be a public record in the custody of the Board.

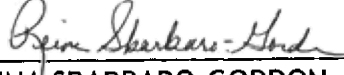
AGREED TO AND ACCEPTED BY:

RESPONDENT


MATTHEW JAMES JUNGLAS
LICENSE No. LPC.14800

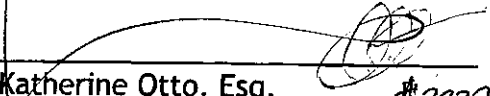
AGREED TO AND ORDERED BY:

STATE BOARD OF Licensed Professional
Counselor Examiners


REINA SBARBARO-GORDON
Program Director

Effective this 7th day of August,
2024.

APPROVED AS TO FORM
FOR RESPONDENT


Katherine Otto, Esq. #39328